

PrEP (Pre-Exposure Prophylaxis) Initiation Counselling Guide for Clinicians

Step 1: If your client is interested in PrEP and has tested negative for HIV, inform them that the following health checks will have to be completed, depending on the method they choose:

Oral PrEP 	Injectable PrEP 
Over 15 years old and weigh 30kg or more	Weigh 35kg or more
Negative HIV test result	Negative HIV test result
No signs of HIV infection	No signs of HIV infection
Kidney function (blood) test if diabetic, hypertensive, 50 years and older, or pregnant	No blood test required

If all of these tests/checks are OK, the client could start PrEP immediately. You do not have to wait for the blood results to start PrEP.

Step 2: Explain the process of Starting PrEP to your client:

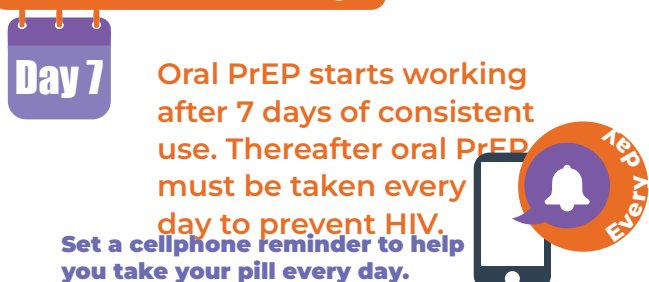
Starting Oral PrEP...

When you start using oral PrEP for the first time, you will:

Receive 1 container of oral PrEP with 28 pills



How soon does it start working?



Return to the clinic after 1 month for an HIV test and check-up, and receive 3 containers of oral PrEP



Return to the clinic every 3 months for an HIV test and check-up, and receive 3 containers of oral PrEP



Starting LEN...

When you start using LEN for the first time, you will:

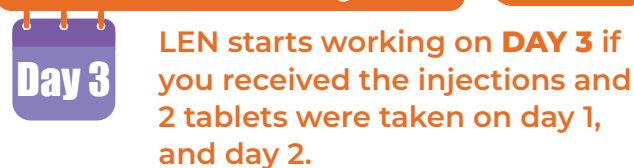
Receive 2 injections and 2 pills



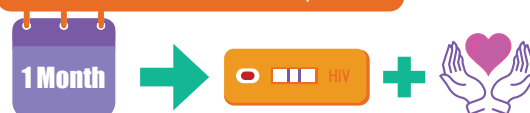
Receive 2 pills to take home, to be taken the next day



How soon does it start working?



Return to the clinic after 1 month for an HIV test and check-up



Return to the clinic every six months for 2 injections



IMPORTANT:

The two tablets that you take on day 1 and day 2, must be taken 24 hours apart, not sooner and not later!

Set a reminder!

Step 3: Provide the correct information and education about PrEP:

Oral PrEP

- ♥ Take a pill a day, every day.
- ♥ **Oral PrEP starts working after taking one pill a day for 7 days.**
- ♥ Use additional protection such as condoms, or abstain from sex.
- ♥ If used correctly, PrEP prevents HIV by more than 90%.
- ♥ PrEP works best if you take one pill a day, every day!
- ♥ You can stop taking PrEP if you feel you no longer need it.
- ♥ If you want to stop PrEP, continue to take the pills for 7 days after your last sexual contact.

Injectable PrEP (LEN)

- ♥ Day 1: 2 injections and 2 tablets
Day 2: 2 tablets
Day 3: **LEN starts working**
- ♥ Use additional protection such as condoms, or abstain from sex on days 1 and 2.
- ♥ Return to the clinic every 6 months for your follow-up injections.
- ♥ LEN prevents HIV by more than 96%.
- ♥ You can stop using LEN if you feel you no longer need it.
- ♥ LEN will only prevent HIV for 28 weeks after your last injection.
- ♥ If you do not receive your LEN injection after 28 weeks, you are no longer protected.
- ♥ Return for a follow-up LEN injection or use a condom, or oral PrEP if you still need to prevent HIV.

Step 4: Provide support for continuation (pill-taking and follow-up clinic visits)

Oral PrEP

- ♥ Remember to take PrEP every day.
- ♥ PrEP tablets can be taken any time of day, with food or without food.
- ♥ If you forget to take a tablet, take it as soon as you remember - if more than 2 days have passed, contact your healthcare provider for guidance.

Injectable PrEP (LEN)

- ♥ It is **important** to remember to take your 2 tablets on day 2 after the injections - without these tablets, LEN is not effective.

REASSURE your client!

- ♥ PrEP is safe even if you are taking hormonal contraceptives, sex hormones or non-prescription drugs.
- ♥ PrEP is safe with alcohol, as long as it does not cause a person to forget to take their daily pill.

REMIND your client!

- ♥ It does not matter which method you choose, you will have to return to the clinic for follow-up visits, the nurse will tell you exactly when!
- ♥ Remember to take your pill(s) and return to the clinic, set an alarm or cellphone reminder.
- ♥ Link the date of your follow-up visit with another important event in your life, like your friend's birthday or even a public holiday... or set a reminder on your phone!

PrEP IS CHOICE
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